

I went into this week's lesson already leaning on Claude Code for my project, so this discussion was less of an intro for me and more of a chance to see where I can improve in my use of the tools I have. Hearing the discussion about Claude code helped me clean up how I use it. I realized that I've been burning through tokens on things I could easily do myself and then handing off the harder tasks to the AI.

I connected this directly to what I have been working on this week. Since my app's main audience is not educated in finance, I thought adding a chatbot could be helpful for questions and clarification. When I explained what I wanted to Claude Code it kept running into a problem getting a local model integrated. It kept getting stuck on dependencies and configurations issues that were chewing through my tokens. Instead of letting it keep going like I normally would I decided I would download Qwen myself, stand it up, and give the path to Claude. This one change made it so Claude could work with something that already existed instead of trying to grab something that didn't exist. This saved me time and tokens I would've previously wasted.

Claude Code's first approach to the integration assumed it could build the local environment on its own, but it couldn't get the AI downloaded. Therefore, I changed my approach instead of watching error after error. Doing a manual step that pushed the AI to succeed reinforced the lessons learned from the discussion this week. Knowing my tool is the real skill when trying to develop a project like my finance app.